

SPITTING COBRA

The AH-1F can mount formidable attacks, using antitank missiles and rockets positioned on either side of the helicopter's stub wings.



Sighting system viewfinder

Artificial horizon

Airspeed indicator

Radio compass

Gunner's seat

FRONT SEAT

The gunner's seat is at the front of the craft; the pilot sits behind (in an elevated seat). The gunner has several electronic aiming devices at his disposal.

Sight control/trigger

AWESOME FIREPOWER

The AH-1S boasts an impressive array of weaponry, found at the front and side of the craft. One eyewitness from the Vietnam War said that when an AH-1S opened up with all its armament, it felt like being "inside an exploding ammo factory."

NARROW TARGET

To ensure that the Cobra presented as small a target as possible to the enemy, its design featured a streamlined fuselage and a narrow profile.

Main rotor blades

Rotor-head fairing

7.62mm minigun

40mm grenade launcher

Armored windshield

Landing skids

Main rotor blades

Rotorhead

Rotormast

Pilot's seat

Specifications (AH-1S)

ENGINE 1,800shp Textron Lycoming T53-L-703 turboshaft

ROTOR DIAMETER 48ft (14.6m)

LENGTH 45ft 6in (13.9m)

WEIGHT 10,200lb (4,267kg)

TOP SPEED 175mph (282kph)

CREW 2

ARMAMENT 1 x three-barrel M197 20mm cannon; 4 x weapons points on stub wings; 8 x BGM-71 TOW missiles; 2 x pods with 7-19 folding-fin aircraft rockets

Upward-hinged side door to cockpit

Turret housing Miniguns and Grenade Launcher